Sidra Coffee ��� Brand strategy summary

Brand strategy summary — Sidra Coffee (سدرة للقهوة)

> **SYSTEM TEST — FICTIONAL CLIENT.** "Sidra Coffee" is invented for testing Creative Agency OS. The three competitors named below are real companies.

Version: v02 **Date:** 2026-11-13 **Prepared by:** Brand Strategist **Language:** English, with Arabic for the name, tagline, values and voice examples **Status:** Direction A approved by the Creative Director acting as client for this test. No real client has approved it. Awaiting quality review. **Replaces for client use:** the v01 working drafts `brand-strategy.md` and `messaging.md`, which are kept unchanged as the record.

How to read the labels: [V] verified fact the client confirmed in the brief · **[D]** decided and recorded in the decision log (test approval) · **[R]** from research, with its limits stated · **[A]** assumption, not confirmed.

1. Summary

Sidra Coffee is a specialty coffee roastery, founded in 2023 and based in Riyadh, that roasts to order weekly [V]. Its goal is to win its first 20 café accounts and look credible to wholesale buyers [V].

The approved direction is **"The weekly roast"** [D]: Sidra Coffee is the roastery organised around one dependable rhythm, your order roasted this week. Reliability is the brand; origin stories are supporting detail. The direction was chosen because it rests on the one verified fact that sets the business apart, answers the brief's own words ("a reliable local roaster") and needs no awards or client names to be believed.

The confirmed tagline is «تُحمَّص لطلبك، كل أسبوع.» / "Roasted for your order. Every week." [D]

Two things must be settled before real use: a trademark attorney's opinion on the name (section 11), and four factual questions only the client can answer (section 11).

2. Audience

	Café owner (primary)	Home brewer (secondary)
Who	Independent café owners in Riyadh [V]; likely owner-operators with 1 to 3 branches [A]	Aged 22 to 40, buy specialty beans online, Arabic first, comfortable in English [V]
Wants	"A reliable local roaster" [V]; the same cup every week [A]	Fresh beans and the right coffee for their brewer [A]
Worries	Late or inconsistent supply; a supplier whose own cafés trade nearby [A]	Stale beans, hype, being talked down to [A]
Persuaded by	Specifics: what is roasted, in what sizes, and a person who answers [A]	Clarity and warmth; coffee terms used naturally [A]

No interviews were held, so motives are assumptions and no named personas have been invented. Recommended validation: five short conversations with Riyadh café owners.

3. Competitive frame

The café owner's question is "which local roaster supplies my café?", not "which coffee brand do I like?". Three leading Saudi roasters were audited [R]. Their messaging was read as search summaries of their own sites, not on the live pages; their home pages were viewed for the visual comparison only.

	What they are, as sourced	What they lead with
Camel Step	Operating since 2013. Sells beans and equipment online, runs cafés across Saudi Arabia, offers training for coffee professionals, serves business customers	Being the pioneer that raised the standard
Elixir Bunn	Headquartered in Riyadh. Founding date disputed between sources (2014 or 2018), so none is stated. Runs cafés; offers wholesale supply, equipment, consulting and training	Roasting as an art; origin stories
Brew92	Describes itself as a specialty café and roastery, founded 2016. Branches in Jeddah, Riyadh, Dammam and Makkah; supplies business partners; offers consultancy and training	Credentials and grading

What this means:

- **All three run their own cafés and all three also sell wholesale.** Training is standard in the category, so Sidra Coffee's barista courses support the offer but do not set it apart.
- **None of the summaries shows a weekly roast-to-order rhythm as the main promise.** This is an inference from absence and is weak: whether competitors also roast to order weekly was not checked [A].
- **"Arabic-first" is not claimed as a differentiator** [D]. Camel Step and Elixir Bunn are both Arabic-led. Arabic as the primary language remains a requirement of the brief and is met in every piece.
- Sidra Coffee has no awards or certifications to publish [V] and does not compete on credentials.

4. Positioning statement

> For independent café owners in Riyadh, and for home brewers who want the same standard, Sidra Coffee is the Riyadh roastery built around a weekly roast-to-order rhythm rather than around its own café counters: a supplier that roasts what you ordered in that week's roast. [D]

Arabic, written natively (for internal use, not a public line):

> «سدرة للقهوة محمصة من الرياض، تعمل على إيقاع واحد: طلبك يُحمَّص هذا الأسبوع. نورّد للمقاهي المستقلة ولمن يحضّر قهوته في بيته.»

Reading limits. "Rather than around its own café counters" says what the brand is organised around. It does **not** say that Sidra Coffee runs no cafés, and it must never be paraphrased that way: that claim is unconfirmed and stays out of every piece [D]. The statement is an internal guide; it is not published copy.

Competitor test. None of the three could use the statement unchanged: each is organised around its own cafés and leads with pioneering, craft or credentials [R]. **Honest limit:** the rhythm is an operating practice a competitor could adopt, so the position is held by keeping the promise, not by the wording.

5. Personality

Trait	Is	Is not	What a designer or writer does with it
Dependable — يُعتمد عليها	Regular, exact, the same every week	Rigid, corporate, cold	One repeatable system; weights and facts given real prominence; nothing changed for novelty
Rooted — بنت الرياض	Local, Arabic-led, at ease in its own language	Folkloric, nostalgic, desert heritage	Arabic leads every lockup and headline, English as the equal second; restraint, not ornament
Plain-spoken — واضحة	Specific, short, factual	Technical for show, poetic, boastful	Short headlines, numbers before adjectives, generous space
Hospitable — مِضيافة	Warm, generous with knowledge	Chatty, cute, salesy	Warmth carried by colour, materials and wording, never by pictures of people

Standing constraints from the brief [V]: no imagery of people; no green-and-white combinations close to large international coffee chains.

6. Promise and proof points

Promise: "Your order, roasted this week." — «طلبك يُحمَّص هذا الأسبوع.» [D]

Proof points available today, all from the brief [V]:

1. Roasts to order weekly.
2. Based in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia.
3. Weekly roasted-to-order wholesale supply for cafés.
4. Roasted specialty beans in 250 g and 1 kg, single-origin and house blends.
5. Short barista courses for café staff.
6. Monthly coffee subscription delivered to homes.
7. Founded 2023, stated plainly and never dressed as heritage.

Not available and never implied [V]: client list, customer numbers, awards, certifications, project portfolio, team names, sales figures.

Not confirmed and never implied [D]: a roast date printed on the bag; a named roast day, delivery day or delivery time; that Sidra Coffee runs no cafés; that single online orders are roasted to order.

7. Values

Value	Arabic	What it means in practice
On schedule	على الموعد	The weekly roast is a commitment, not a marketing line
Plain facts	كلام واضح	We say what it is and what to do with it. No superlatives

Value	Arabic	What it means in practice
On the café's side	في صفّ المقهى	The café's cup is the product; our name comes second
Hospitality	ضيافة	Expertise is shared generously, never used to talk down

Purpose: so that an independent café never has to wonder what is in the bag or when it will arrive. **Vision:** to be the roaster Riyadh's independent cafés name first. **Mission:** roast every order in the weekly roast, for Riyadh's independent cafés and home brewers, and help café teams brew it well. [D] Purpose and vision are ambitions, not claims. "On schedule" guides behaviour inside the company; in public copy it must not be worded as a delivery promise until the client can publish its days.

8. Messaging and tagline

Tagline (confirmed) [D]: «تُحمَّص لطلبك، كل أسبوع.» / "Roasted for your order. Every week."

- The diacritics on «تُحمَّص» are part of the line and are always set: without them the word can be read as "you roast".
- It rests on a verified fact for wholesale. Its use towards home brewers placing single online orders waits for the client's answer to question 3 in section 11.
- It has not been checked for prior use by another brand. This is not a legal clearance.

Value proposition: «سدرة للقهوة محمصة قهوة مختصة من الرياض، تحمّص طلبك في تحميصة الأسبوع، للمقاهي المستقلة ولمن يحضّر قهوته في بيته.» Sidra Coffee is a specialty coffee roastery in Riyadh that roasts your order in the weekly roast, for independent cafés and for people who brew at home.

Key messages:

Audience	Arabic	English	Basis
Cafés	نحمّص كل أسبوع، وعلى طلبك أنت.	We roast every week, to your order.	[V]
Cafés	محمصة من الرياض، لمقاهي الرياض.	A Riyadh roastery for Riyadh cafés.	[V]
Cafés	دورات قصيرة لفريق مقهاك.	Short courses for your baristas.	[V]
Home	محاصيل مفردة وخلطات البيت، 250 غ أو 1 كغ.	Single origins and house blends, 250 g or 1 kg.	[V]
Home	اشترك، وتصلك قهوتك كل شهر.	Subscribe and your coffee arrives every month.	[V]

Held until confirmed: «نورّد للمقاهي ولا ننافسها.» / "We supply cafés. We do not compete with them." (question 1), and any "roasted for your order" line aimed at single online orders (question 3).

9. Tone of voice

Arabic. Clear modern Arabic (فصحى مبسّطة) with light Gulf warmth; the register is an assumption to confirm with the client [A]. Short sentences, direct verbs, numbers before adjectives. Written natively, never translated from the English. We address the café owner as a peer and the home brewer as a guest, not a pupil. Common coffee terms stay as people say them (إسبريسو، V60). Western numerals (0123) [V]. Arabic punctuation: ، ؟ ؛ «».

السبب	لا تكتب هكذا	اكتب هكذا	
لغة شركات لا يقولها أحد	نتشرّف بتقديم حلول توريد متكاملة لقطاع المقاهي.	نحمّص كل أسبوع، وعلى طلبك أنت.	للمقاهي
تفضيل لا دليل عليه	أجود أنواع القهوة المختصة في المملكة.	دورات قصيرة لفريق مقهاك.	للمقاهي
زخرفة بلا معلومة	انطلق في رحلة حسّية فريدة مع حبوب استثنائية.	عندك V60؟ ابدأ بهذه.	للبيت
ادّعاء فخامة لا يشبهنا	قهوة فاخرة لعشّاق التميّز.	محاصيل مفردة وخلطات البيت، 250 غ أو 1 كغ.	للبيت

English. Plain, specific, short sentences. Confident without superlatives. The same facts as the Arabic, in its own rhythm.

	Do	Don't	Why
Cafés	We roast every week, to your order.	We deliver best-in-class coffee solutions to the F&B sector.	Corporate filler
Cafés	Short courses for your baristas.	Award-winning beans trusted by Riyadh's top cafés.	Invented awards and clients; never
Home	Brewing with a V60? Start with this one.	Embark on a sensory journey of exceptional beans.	Decoration without information
Home	Single origins and house blends, 250 g or 1 kg.	Simply the finest coffee in the Kingdom.	Unprovable superlative

Words we use: محمصة، يُحمَّص لطلبك، كل أسبوع، طازجة / roastery, roasted to order, every week, fresh. **Words we avoid:** الأفضل، الأجود، رقم 1، فاخر، حصري، شغف، رحلة / best, finest, premium, award-winning, passion, journey. **Never, in either language:** awards, certifications, customer numbers or named clients; competitor names or comparisons; a roast day, delivery day or delivery time; a roast date on the bag; any claim that beans are Saudi-grown; the placeholder phone number.

10. Name rule

1. Always the full name: «سدرة للقهوة» in Arabic and "Sidra Coffee" in English. In English running copy, pair it with what the company is: "Sidra Coffee, a Riyadh roastery".
2. Never «سدرة» or "Sidra" alone in text. The wordmark «سدرة» inside the logo is the only exception.
3. Never place the name beside an origin or variety word, on a label or in a sentence.
4. Never pun on or refer to «سدرة المنتهى».

The reason for rules 1 to 3 is in section 11: on its own, the word is a coffee variety on a bag and a place on the Riyadh map. [D]

11. Known risks and open questions for the client

Name risks. A preliminary web check was run on 2026-11-13. It read search summaries only; no trademark register was searched. **It is not a legal clearance.**

Risk	Rating	What was found
Alshaya "Sidra" dining complex in Riyadh	**High**	Search summaries describe a multi-restaurant dining destination named "Sidra", operated by Alshaya, announced for Riyadh in 2018 (and one in Kuwait), with a Starbucks among its tenants. Same word, same city, food and beverage. Not known: whether it still trades under that name, or what Alshaya has registered
"Sidra" is a coffee variety	Medium	"Sidra" is used as a variety name by specialty roasters, and search summaries show Riyadh coffee businesses selling coffee under it. The word may be treated as descriptive for coffee, and buyers may expect that variety in the bag

Action required before any real use: a written opinion from a trademark attorney on "Sidra / سدره / سدرة" in classes 30, 43 and 35, in Saudi Arabia first and then the GCC, covering both points above. The name rule in section 10 reduces confusion; it does not remove the legal question. The logo device needs its own search and is outside this document.

Questions only the client can answer:

1. **Does Sidra Coffee run, or plan to run, its own cafés?** If not, "partner, not rival" becomes the strongest message available. If so, the phrase "rather than around its own café counters" in the positioning statement should be reworded.
2. **Can a roast day and a delivery day be published, and is the roast date printed on the bag?** Until then no piece states or implies them.
3. **Are single online orders and subscription coffee also roasted to order?** The brief confirms it for wholesale and in general terms only.
4. **How are enquiries answered, and what are the real contact details?** For the test, replies are by email to a placeholder address; the phone number in the brief is a placeholder and appears nowhere.

12. What is verified and what is assumed

Status	Items
Verified by the client in the brief	Founded 2023; based in Riyadh; roasts to order weekly; the four products and services in section 6; the two audiences as described; the 20-account goal; bilingual with Arabic primary; Western numerals; no imagery of people; avoid chain-like green and white
Decided, by test approval only	Direction A; the positioning statement; purpose, vision, mission and values; personality; the promise; the tagline; the name rule; "Arabic-first" not claimed as a differentiator
From research, with limits	Competitor facts in section 3 (search summaries of their own sites; home pages viewed); the two name risks (search summaries, no register searched)
Assumptions, to validate	All audience motives and the "1 to 3 branches" profile; the Arabic register; that no competitor leads with weekly roast-to-order; that the name's link to the sidr tree is intended
Unconfirmed, kept out of all copy	No cafés of its own; roast and delivery days; roast date on the bag; roast-to-order for single online orders; real contact details

All Arabic in this document needs a proofread by a native reader before it reaches a real client.